

out for an early drive Friday or Saturday morning to find unadvertised gems and browse the best selection. The cliché “the early bird gets the worm” is almost always true when shopping an early morning garage sale!

Estate sales run in a similar way to garage sales, but beware of higher prices when shopping one. I stopped by my first estate sale earlier this year and was shocked by how much everything cost. I later learned that private companies usually manage the family’s belongings, and an extra middleman means you don’t get as great of a deal. I still wouldn’t be afraid to try to negotiate a better price, though—it certainly doesn’t hurt!

Local Facebook sales groups are another great place to look for used big-ticket items, and you can do that from the comfort of your own home. Just type “virtual yard sale” or “garage sale” into the search box on Facebook along with your closest town, city, or county for a list of groups near you. Another perk is the ability to list anything you want to sell too.

5. PLAN PURCHASES AROUND SEASONAL SALES

Although you can’t always “schedule” an exact time to buy a big-ticket item, it’s still smart to have an idea of when the typical seasonal sales are and how long they last. Here’s a peek at current sales trends during each month so you know when the best prices take effect:

January: Fitness Equipment & TVs

February: Indoor Furniture

March: Electronics & Cameras

April: Lawn Tools & Equipment

May: Camping/Outdoor Gear & Mattresses

June: Indoor Furniture & Computers